

TECD 1100 – Commercial Driver's License Class A (6 Credits)

Course Description

The Commercial Drivers' License - Class A Course prepares students in classroom theory, backing skills, and entry-level driving skills including behind the wheel range and public road practice. Students demonstrate proficiency and competence in accordance with Federal/ State regulations, and college requirements.

Course Objectives

- Demonstrate basic truck operating procedures.
- Demonstrate safe operating procedures.
- Learn and practice advanced operating procedures.
- Practice vehicle inspections (pre/post-trip).
- Review non-driving activities.

Course Outline

- Orientation, Control Systems/Dashboard, Pre- and Post-Trip Inspections
- Basic Control, Shifting/Operating Transmissions, Backing and Docking, Coupling and Uncoupling
- Visual Search, Communication, Distracted Driving, Speed Management, Space Management, Night Operations
- Extreme Driving Conditions, Hazard Perception, Skid Control/Recovery, Jackknifing, and Other Emergencies, Railroad-Highway Grade Crossings
- Identification and Diagnosis of Malfunctions, Roadside Inspections, Maintenance, Handling and Documenting Cargo, Environmental Compliance Issues
- Hours of Service Requirements, Fatigue and Wellness Awareness, Post-Crash Procedures, External Communications, Whistleblower/Coercion, Trip Planning, Drugs/Alcohol, Medical Requirements
- Human Trafficking, CSA, Special Rigs, Crossing the Canadian Border, Basic Business Practices, HAZMAT
- Pre-Trip and Skills
- Road 1
- Road 2
- Road 3

Textbook & Reading Materials

Entry Level Driver Training Obtaining a CDL (ISBN: 9781680084931)

Log Book Holder, Log Book, Ruler (ISBN: B083P53B8T)

Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations Pocketbook

Assignments & Assessments

Orientation
Orientation Acknowledgement
Commercial Driver's License Class A Syllabus
Chapter 1 Orientation PowerPoint
Chapter 1 Orientation Test
Chapter 2 Control Systems/Dashboard PowerPoint
Video - 2.1 Lights
Video - 2.2 Mirrors
Video - 2.3 Horn
Video - 2.4 Door Locks
Video - 2.5 Vehicle Instruments
Chapter 2 Control Systems/Dashboard Test
Chapter 3 Pre and Post Trip Inspections PowerPoint
Video - 3.1 Types of Inspections
Video - 3.2 Pre-Trip Inspection
Video - 3.3 Post-Trip Inspection
Chapter 3 Pre and Post Trip Inspections Test
Chapter 4 Basic Control PowerPoint
Video - 4.1 Right Turns
Video - 4.2 Left Turns
Video - 4.3 Roundabouts
Video - 4.4 On and Off Ramps | Chapter 4 Basic Control Test
Chapter 5 Shifting/Operating Transmissions PowerPoint
Chapter 5 Shifting/Operating Transmissions Test
Chapter 6 Backing and Docking PowerPoint
Video - 6.0 Get Out and Look.mp4
Video - 6.1 Spotter
Video - 6.2 Steering Techniques
Video - 6.3 Straight Line Backing
Video - 6.4 Alley Dock Backing
Video - 6.5 Offset Backing
Video - 6.6 Sight Side Jackknife Backing
Video - 6.7 Blind Side Jackknife Backing | Chapter 6 Backing and Docking Test
Chapter 7 Coupling and Uncoupling PowerPoint
Video - 7.1 Inspecting the Fifth Wheel
Video - 7.2 Backing into Position and Checking the Trailer Height
Video - 7.3 Inspecting the Coupling
Video - 7.4 Landing Gear | Chapter 7 Coupling and Uncoupling Test
Chapter 8 Visual Search PowerPoint
Video - 8.1 Distance Scanning
Video - 8.2 Turning at Intersections
Video - 8.3 Roundabouts
Chapter 9 Communication PowerPoint
Video - 9.1 Introduction
Video - 9.2 Signals
Video - 9.3 Headlights
Video - 9.4 Horns
Video - 9.5 Communication from Other Drivers | Chapter 9 Communication Test
Chapter 10 Distracted Driving PowerPoint
Video - 10.1 Introduction
Video - 10.2 Types of Distractions
Video - 10.3 Effects of Auto-Pilot
Video - 10.4 Managing Driving Distractions | Chapter 10 Distracted Driving Test
Chapter 11 Speed Management PowerPoint
Video - 11.1 Stopping Distance
Video - 11.2 Road Hazards
Video - 11.3 Weather Conditions | Chapter 11 Speed Management Test
Chapter 12 Space Management PowerPoint
Video - 12.1 Managing Space Ahead of Your Vehicle
Video - 12.2 Managing Space Behind Your Vehicle
Video - 12.3 Managing Space to the Sides of Your Vehicle
Video - 12.4 Managing Space Above Your Vehicle
Video - 12.5 Managing Space Below Your Vehicle
Chapter 12 Space Management Test
Chapter 13 Night Operation PowerPoint
Video - 13.1 Night Driving Pre-Trip Inspection
Video - 13.2 Headlights
Video - 13.3 Night Driving Road Hazards
Video - 13.4 Night Driving Visual Limitations
Video - 13.5 Fatigue | Chapter 13 Night Operations Test
Chapter 14 Extreme Driving Conditions PowerPoint
Video - 14.1 Extreme Weather Vehicle Preparation
Video - 14.2 Extreme Weather - Fog
Video - 14.3 Extreme Weather - Rain
Video - 14.4 Extreme Weather - Wind
Video - 14.5 Extreme Weather - Snow
Video - 14.6 Extreme Weather - Ice | Chapter 14 Extreme Driving Conditions Test
Chapter 15 Hazard Perception PowerPoint
Video - 15.1 Pavement Drop Offs
Video - 15.2 Road Construction Work Zones
Video - 15.3 Road Debris
Video - 15.4 Off Ramps/On Ramps

Video - 15.5 Parked Vehicles
 Video - 15.6 Pedestrians/Animals
 Video - 15.7 Disabled Vehicles
 Video - 15.8 Other Drivers
 Chapter 15 Hazard Perception Test
 Chapter 16 Skid Control Recovery, Jackknifing, and Other Emergencies PowerPoint
 Video - 16.1 Skid Recovery
 Video - 16.2 Avoiding an Oncoming Vehicle
 Video - 16.3 Avoiding a Stopped or Stationary Vehicle
 Video - 16.4 Avoiding a Merging Vehicle
 Video - 16.5 Tire Blowout
 Chapter 16 Skid Control/Recovery, Jackknifing, and Other Emergencies Test
 Chapter 17 Railroad Highway Grade Crossings PowerPoint
 Video - 17.1 Railroad Crossings I
 Chapter 17 Railroad Highway Grade Crossings Test
 Chapter 18 Identification and Diagnosis of Malfunctions PowerPoint
 Video - 18.1 Glad Hands Inspection
 Video - 18.2 Tire Tread Inflation I
 Chapter 18 Identification and Diagnosis of Malfunctions Test
 Chapter 19 Roadside Inspections PowerPoint
 Video - 19.1 Who Gets Inspected
 Video - 19.2 Transfer of ELD to ATA
 Video - 19.3 Inspection Decals I Chapter 19 Roadside Inspections Test
 Chapter 20 Maintenance PowerPoint
 Video - 20.1 Pre-Trip Inspection
 Video - 20.2 On the Road Inspection
 Video - 20.3 Post-Trip Inspection I Chapter 20 Maintenance Test
 Chapter 21 Handling and Documenting Cargo PowerPoint
 Video - 21.1 Tiedowns for Dry Van Trailers
 Video - 21.2 Tiedowns for Flatbed Trailers
 Video - 21.3 Blocking
 Video - 21.4 Bracing
 Video - 21.5 Dunnage
 Video - 21.6 Friction Mats
 Video - 21.7 Load Bars
 Video - 21.8 Edge Protection
 Video - 21.9 Top Heavy Loads
 Video - 21.10 Weight Balance
 Video - 21.11 Parking Shortages
 Chapter 21 Handling and Documenting Cargo Test
 Chapter 22 Environmental Compliance Issues PowerPoint
 Chapter 22 Environmental Compliance Issues Test
 Chapter 23 Hours of Service Requirements PowerPoint

Video - 23.1 On-Duty Time
 Video - 23.2 If Your ELD Fails
 Video - 23.3 How to Complete a Manual Log
 Chapter 23 Hours of Service Requirements Test
 Chapter 24 Fatigue and Wellness Awareness PowerPoint
 Video - 24.1 Personal Health Driving
 Video - 24.2 Fatigue
 Video - 24.3 Vehicle Entry Exit
 Video - 24.4 Stopping on the Side of the Road
 Video - 24.5 Staying Safe When on the Road
 Chapter 24 Fatigue and Wellness Awareness Test
 Chapter 25 Post-Crash Procedures PowerPoint
 Video - 25.1 Stop Immediately
 Video - 25.2 Warning Devices
 Video - 25.3 Document the Accident
 Chapter 25 Post Crash Procedures Test
 Chapter 26 External Communications PowerPoint
 Chapter 26 External Communications Test
 Chapter 27 Whistleblower Coercion PowerPoint
 Chapter 27 Whistleblower Coercion Test
 Chapter 28 Trip Planning PowerPoint
 Video - 28.1 Estimating Trip Time
 Video - 28.2 Global Positioning Systems
 Video - 28.3 Trip Planning Best Practices
 Chapter 28 Trip Planning Test
 Chapter 29 Drugs/Alcohol PowerPoint
 Video - 29.1 Reasonable Suspicion
 Video - 29.2 Alcohol Testing Procedures
 Video - 29.3 Drug Testing
 Video - 29.4 Refusing to Test
 Chapter 29 Drugs/Alcohol Test
 Chapter 30 Medical Requirements PowerPoint
 Chapter 30 Medical Requirements Test
 End of Course Survey
 Chapter 31 Human Trafficking PowerPoint
 Video - 31.1 People at Risk
 Video - 31.2 Trafficker Profile
 Video - 31.3 Potential Trafficking Victims
 Video - 31.4 Vehicles Used for Trafficking
 Video - 31.5 Locations Used for Trafficking
 Video - 31.6 Know How to Respond
 Chapter 31 Human Trafficking Test
 Chapter 32 CSA PowerPoint
 Chapter 32 CSA Test
 Chapter 33 Special Rigs PowerPoint
 Video - 33.1 Refrigerated Trailers
 Chapter 33 Special Rigs Test
 Chapter 34 Crossing the Canadian Border PowerPoint
 Video - 34.1 Canada HOS General Rules South of 60

Video - 34.2 Canada HOS Sleeper Berth Rules South of 60
Video - 34.3 Canada HOS General Rules North of 60
Video - 34.4 Canada HOS Sleeper Berth Rules North of 60
Video - 34.5 Canada HOS Drivers Daily Log
Chapter 34 Crossing The Canadian Border Test
Chapter 35 Basic Business Practices PowerPoint

Chapter 35 Basic Business Practices Test
Haz-Mat Test
Pre-Trip Assignment
Skills
Road

Subject to change. Please consult your Canvas course for the most current instructions and updates.

Classroom Hours

Classroom (Dates Vary)

Mo, Tu, W, Th, Fr
8:00 AM - 5:00 PM

Driving Hours (Dates Vary)

Mo, Tu, W, Th, Fr
7:00 AM - 6:00 PM

For a full list of course hours visit: [Course Schedule](#)

Instructor Contact Information

James Coats — jcoats@stech.edu
Christopher Macias — cmacias@stech.edu
Chantry Brindley — cbrindley@stech.edu
Terrance Bresina — tbresina@stech.edu

Office Hours: By appointment

Email is the preferred method of communication; you will receive a response within 24 hours during regular business hours.

Canvas Information

Canvas is where course content, grades, and communication will reside for this course.

- Canvas URL: stech.instructure.com
 - For Canvas passwords or any other computer-related technical support contact Student Services.
 - For Regular Hours and Weekdays call (435) 586 - 2899
 - For After Hours and Weekends call (435) 865 - 3929 (Leave a message if no response)
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Policies

Course Grading

Students must achieve 80% (B-) or higher to pass graded work. Your grades are weighted in the following categories: Classroom Work – 30%, Pre-trip – 20%, Skills – 20%, Road – 30%.

Grade Scale: The following grading scale will be used to determine a letter grade.

A : 94 - 100%	A- : 90 - 93%	B+ : 87 - 89%	B : 83 - 86%
B- : 80 - 82%	C+ : 77 - 79%	C : 73 - 76%	C- : 70 - 72%
D+ : 67 - 69%	D : 63 - 66%	D- : 60 - 62%	F : 0 - 59%

Course Policies

Class attendance is required during your scheduled time. The Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration (FMCSA) requires everyone wishing to obtain a Commercial Drivers License (CDL) to attend an approved training program and have documented hours. Cell Phone Use – When driving or observing in the semi-trucks cell phones are not permitted, no exceptions; it's the law. Drug & Alcohol Safety Policy – Drug and alcohol use and abuse during the duration of the training program are strictly prohibited. If you are suspected or found abusing any substance, Southwest Technical College has the right to require an additional full drug screen at the student expense. Each individual is responsible for safety, and we reserve the right to remove anyone from the training program which includes in class instruction and/or in-truck driving training for any unsafe practices. This will be determined by the instructor and college administration. No exceptions! Smoking is not permitted in the semi-trucks. Industry Environment – The program is designed to provide the student with real-world hands-on driving experience. If you are unsafe behind the wheel while driving, you will be asked to stop the vehicle and removed from driving. This decision is from the instructors and director.

Additional Information

InformaCast Statement: Southwest Tech uses InformaCast to ensure the safety and well-being of our students. In times of emergency, such as weather closures and delays, this app allows us to promptly deliver notifications directly to your mobile devices. To stay informed and receive real-time updates, we encourage all students to sign up for notifications. Your safety is our priority, and staying connected ensures a swift response to any unforeseen circumstances. More information and directions for signing up are available at: <https://stech.edu/emergency-notifications/>

Internet Acceptable Use Policy: The student is expected to review and follow the Southwest Technical College Internet Safety Policy at: <https://stech.edu/students/policies/>

Student Code of Conduct Policy: The student is expected to review and follow the Southwest Technical College Student Code of Conduct Policy at: <https://stech.edu/students/policies/>

Accommodations: Students with medical, psychological, learning, or other disabilities desiring accommodations or services under ADA, must contact the Student Services Office. Student Services determines eligibility for and authorizes the provision of these accommodations and services. Students must voluntarily disclose that they have a disability, request an accommodation, and provide documentation of their disability. Students with disabilities may apply for accommodations, based on an eligible disability, through the Student Services office located at 757 W. 800 S., Cedar City, UT 84720, and by phone at (435) 586-2899. No diagnostic services are currently available through Southwest Technical College.

Safety and Building Maintenance: The College has developed and follows a variety of plans to ensure the safe and effective operation of its facilities and programs. The following plans are available online: 1) Facilities Operations and Maintenance Plan; 2) Technical Infrastructure Plan; and 3) Health and Safety Plan.

Withdrawals and Refunds: Please refer to the Southwest Technical College Refund Policy at: <https://stech.edu/students/policies/>

Any high school or adult student, who declares a technical training objective is eligible for admission at Southwest Technical College (Southwest Tech). Program-specific admissions requirements may exist and will be listed on the Southwest Tech website. A high school diploma or equivalent is not required for admission but is mandatory for students seeking Title IV Federal Financial Aid.

Non-Discriminatory Policy: Southwest Technical College affirms its commitment to promote the goals of fairness and equity in all aspects of the educational enterprise, and bases its policies on the idea of global human dignity.

Southwest Tech is committed to a policy of nondiscrimination. No otherwise qualified person may be excluded from participation in or be subjected to discrimination in any course, program or activity because of race, age, color, religion, sex, pregnancy, national origin or disability. Southwest Technical College does not discriminate on the basis of sex in the education programs or activities that it operates, as required by Title IX and 34 CFR part 106. The requirement not to discriminate in education programs or activities extends to admission and employment. Inquiries about Title IX and its regulations to STECH may be referred to the Title IX Coordinator, to the Department of Education, and/or to the Office for Civil rights.

If you believe you have experienced discrimination or harassment on our campus, please contact the Title IX Coordinator, Cory Estes: cestes@stech.edu, (435) 865-3938.

For special accommodations, please contact the ADA Coordinator, Cyndie Tracy: ctracy@stech.edu, (435) 865-3944.

Southwest Technical College
757 West 800 South
Cedar City, UT 84720
info@stech.edu
(435) 586-2899